LESSON 1

Welcome to Biblical Herbalism

God as Creator • Plants as Provision • Herbal Study as Stewardship

Course: NHMEC Biblical Herbalism Foundations
Module: Module 2.1 — Biblical Herbalism
Lesson: Lesson 1
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Lesson Overview

Welcome to **Biblical Herbalism Foundations**. This lesson introduces students to the heart of biblical herbal study: recognizing God as Creator, understanding plants as part of His provision, and learning how to study herbs with wisdom, prayer, discernment, and responsibility.

Biblical Herbalism is not about worshiping plants, following trends, making medical claims, or replacing professional healthcare. Biblical Herbalism is the study of herbs, foods, trees, oils, seeds, spices, and natural resources through a Christian worldview. It teaches us to honor God for what He created, care for the body as a temple, and use wisdom when learning about natural wellness.

In this course, students will learn how to look at herbs through Scripture, traditional use, safety, stewardship, prayer, and Christian discernment. The goal is not to become prideful in knowledge, but to become careful, compassionate, and responsible in how we study and share herbal education.

Lesson Scripture Foundations

Genesis 1:29 KJV

“And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat.”

Psalm 104:14 KJV

“He causeth the grass to grow for the cattle, and herb for the service of man: that he may bring forth food out of the earth.”

Ezekiel 47:12 KJV

“And by the river upon the bank thereof, on this side and on that side, shall grow all trees for meat, whose leaf shall not fade, neither shall the fruit thereof be consumed: it shall bring forth new fruit according to his months, because their waters they issued out of the sanctuary: and the fruit thereof shall be for meat, and the leaf thereof for medicine.”

1 Corinthians 6:19–20 KJV

“What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?
For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.”

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Explain what Biblical Herbalism means from a Christian perspective.
2. Understand that God is the Creator and ultimate healer.
3. Recognize plants as part of God’s provision, not objects of worship.
4. Identify why discernment is necessary in herbal study.
5. Explain the importance of staying within educational scope.
6. Begin developing a personal biblical foundation for herbal learning.
7. Complete a reflection on stewardship, faith, and herbal education.

Opening Teaching

Biblical Herbalism begins with this truth: **God is the Creator.**

Before there was an herbal book, a garden journal, a materia medica, a tincture bottle, or a wellness plan, there was God. The plants did not create themselves. The herbs did not assign themselves purpose. The trees, seeds, leaves, flowers, roots, and fruits all came from the wisdom of the Creator.

When we study herbs as Christians, we are not studying creation apart from God. We are studying creation as a witness of His provision, order, wisdom, and care.

Genesis 1:29 shows us that God gave herbs bearing seed and fruit-bearing trees for food. Psalm 104:14 says that God causes herbs to grow for the service of man. Ezekiel 47:12 gives a prophetic picture of trees whose fruit is for food and whose leaves are for medicine. These scriptures help us see that plants are not strange to the Bible. They are woven throughout Scripture as food, fragrance, oil, incense, cleansing, anointing, symbolism, and practical provision.

However, Biblical Herbalism must always begin with spiritual order.

We honor the Creator above the creation.

We do not worship herbs.
We do not put our faith in plants.
We do not treat herbs as magical objects.
We do not use herbs as a replacement for God.
We do not use herbs as a replacement for wisdom, prayer, medical care, or personal responsibility.

Herbs are part of God's creation. They may be studied, used, prepared, grown, and appreciated. But they must never become idols.

What Is Biblical Herbalism?

Biblical Herbalism is the faith-centered study of plants, herbs, foods, oils, spices, trees, and natural resources through the lens of Scripture, Christian discernment, and responsible wellness education.

Biblical Herbalism asks questions such as:

What does Scripture say about plants, food, oils, and healing?
How did people in biblical times use herbs, foods, and oils in daily life?
How can Christians study herbs without participating in ungodly practices?
How can we use herbs safely and responsibly?
How can herbal education support stewardship of the body?
How can we teach others without diagnosing, prescribing, or making medical claims?
How can we keep God first in all wellness education?

Biblical Herbalism is not the same as occult herbalism, magical herbalism, spellwork, witchcraft, sorcery, or creation worship. The Christian student must learn to separate herbal education from spiritual practices that do not align with the Word of God.

A Christian can study plants as part of God's creation while rejecting any practice that gives spiritual power, worship, or authority to the plant itself.

God as Creator

The first foundation of Biblical Herbalism is that God created the heavens and the earth. This means the natural world belongs to Him.

The herbs belong to Him.
The soil belongs to Him.
The trees belong to Him.
The harvest belongs to Him.
The wisdom to understand creation belongs to Him.

When we study herbs, we are not studying something separate from God's authority. We are studying something that points back to His design.

This should create humility in the student. Herbal knowledge should never make a person prideful, boastful, reckless, or spiritually careless. The more we learn, the more we should realize how much wisdom is required.

A Christian herbal student should say:

"Lord, teach me how to study wisely."
"Lord, keep me from error."
"Lord, help me honor You in this."
"Lord, help me serve people with compassion and truth."
"Lord, help me never worship the creation more than the Creator."

Plants as Provision

Scripture shows that God provided plants for food, nourishment, beauty, fragrance, and practical use. Throughout the Bible, we see references to herbs, oils, spices, trees, fruits, grains, seeds, resins, and gardens.

Some examples include:

Olive oil
Frankincense
Myrrh
Aloes
Cinnamon
Mint
Rue
Garlic
Figs
Grapes
Pomegranates
Almonds
Lentils
Barley
Wheat
Flax
Honey
Cedar
Hyssop

These natural resources had practical uses in daily life. Some were used for food. Some were used for fragrance. Some were used in cleansing. Some were used in worship settings. Some were used in burial customs. Some were used as gifts. Some were used for oil, lamps, skin care, or household needs.

As students of Biblical Herbalism, we must be careful not to exaggerate what the Bible says. Just because a plant is mentioned in Scripture does not mean we should make modern medical claims about it. We study with respect, but we also study with accuracy.

For example, the Bible may mention a plant, oil, or spice in a historical or symbolic context. That does not automatically mean the Bible is giving us a modern formula, prescription, or treatment plan.

A responsible Christian herbal student learns to ask:

Where is this plant mentioned?
What was happening in the passage?
Was it being used as food, fragrance, oil, medicine, symbol, offering, or trade item?
What is the difference between biblical context and modern use?
What safety concerns should be considered today?
How can I speak about this herb without making claims I cannot support?

Herbal Study as Stewardship

Stewardship means caring for what God has entrusted to us.

God has entrusted us with our bodies.
God has entrusted us with creation.
God has entrusted us with knowledge.
God has entrusted us with influence.
God has entrusted us with our words.

Because of this, herbal study is not only about learning plants. It is about learning responsibility.

A Christian herbal student must be a good steward in five areas:

1. Stewardship of the Body

The body is not something to abuse, ignore, or idolize. Scripture teaches that the body is the temple of the Holy Ghost. This means we should care for the body with gratitude, discipline, and wisdom.

Caring for the body may include nourishment, rest, hydration, movement, prayer, emotional healing, wise food choices, and learning about herbs. But caring for the body also includes knowing when to seek proper medical care.

Biblical Herbalism does not reject doctors. Biblical Herbalism does not teach students to avoid emergency care. Biblical Herbalism does not teach people to stop medication. Biblical Herbalism teaches responsibility, wisdom, and whole-person stewardship.

2. Stewardship of Creation

Plants should be used respectfully. We should not waste, overharvest, misuse, or treat creation carelessly. When we grow, gather, purchase, or prepare herbs, we should remember that the earth is the Lord's.

Good stewardship includes:

Proper plant identification
Ethical harvesting
Avoiding endangered plants when possible
Using clean and safe preparation methods
Respecting dosage and safety guidelines
Keeping herbs away from children and pets when needed
Labeling preparations clearly
Avoiding careless claims

3. Stewardship of Knowledge

Not everything online is true. Not every herbal claim is safe. Not every traditional remedy is appropriate for every person. Not every herb is gentle. Not every natural product is harmless.

A Christian herbal student must be willing to study carefully.

Good stewardship of knowledge means we do not repeat claims simply because they sound exciting. We learn to research, compare, pray, ask questions, and remain teachable.

4. Stewardship of Words

Words matter. A Christian herbal student should not say:

"This herb cures cancer."
"This tea treats your infection."
"You do not need your medication."
"This will heal you."
"Doctors are unnecessary."
"This works for everyone."

Instead, safer educational language includes:

"This herb has traditionally been used to support…"
"This plant is commonly studied for…"
"This preparation may be used as part of general wellness education…"
"Please check with your healthcare provider, especially if pregnant, nursing, medicated, or managing a

medical condition."
"This is not medical advice."
"This is for educational purposes only."

5. Stewardship of Ministry

If herbalism is used in a Christian ministry setting, it must be handled with compassion and humility. People who are sick, grieving, overwhelmed, or afraid should never be shamed. We do not blame people for illness. We do not promise healing outcomes. We do not use fear to sell products. We do not present ourselves as saviors.

Jesus is the Savior.
God is the healer.
We are servants.

Discernment in Biblical Herbalism

Discernment is one of the most important parts of this course.

A Christian student may come across herbal teachings connected to many different spiritual systems. Some may include practices that are not aligned with biblical faith. This is why students must learn to separate plant knowledge from spiritual error.

A Christian can learn about chamomile without practicing witchcraft.
A Christian can study lavender without using spellwork.
A Christian can grow herbs without worshiping the earth.
A Christian can make tea without adopting New Age beliefs.
A Christian can appreciate creation without bowing to creation.

Discernment asks:

Does this practice honor God?
Does this practice give spiritual power to the plant?
Does this practice lead me away from Scripture?
Does this practice involve divination, spellwork, sorcery, or occult ritual?
Does this practice cause confusion in my spirit?
Can I study this plant while keeping Christ first?

Biblical Herbalism does not require fear of plants. But it does require discernment about spiritual practices.

The Christian student should stay rooted in prayer, Scripture, humility, and wise counsel.

Educational Scope of This Course

This course is for education only.

Students are not being trained to diagnose disease.
Students are not being trained to prescribe herbs.
Students are not being trained to treat illness.
Students are not being trained to replace doctors.
Students are not being trained to tell others to stop medications.
Students are not being trained to make disease claims.

Students are being trained to study Biblical Herbalism as a faith-centered educational subject.

Students may learn how to:

Study herbs responsibly
Read biblical passages involving plants
Understand traditional herbal uses
Create educational herb profiles
Practice safety awareness
Use proper disclaimers
Encourage stewardship of the body
Integrate prayer and scripture appropriately
Serve with compassion and humility

Teacher’s Teaching Notes

When teaching this lesson, emphasize that Biblical Herbalism must be balanced.

Some Christians fear herbs because they associate herbalism with witchcraft, New Age spirituality, or occult traditions. Other people run too far the other direction and begin to treat herbs as magical cure-alls. Biblical Herbalism must avoid both extremes.

The balanced Christian position is this:

God created plants.
Plants can be studied.
Plants can be useful.
Plants are not God.
Plants are not magic.
Plants must be used wisely.
The body must be cared for responsibly.
The student must stay rooted in Scripture.
God must remain first.

Encourage students to think of this course as a foundation. They are not expected to know every herb yet. They are learning how to think biblically, safely, and responsibly before going deeper into herbal study.

Student Reflection

Take a few minutes to answer the following questions in your notebook or student workbook.

1. What does Genesis 1:29 teach you about God's provision?
2. What does Psalm 104:14 teach you about herbs and service?
3. What does 1 Corinthians 6:19–20 teach you about caring for the body?
4. What is the difference between appreciating creation and worshiping creation?
5. Why is discernment important for a Christian studying herbalism?
6. How can herbal knowledge become dangerous if it is used without wisdom?
7. How can a Christian herbal student use knowledge with humility?

Vocabulary Words

Biblical Herbalism: The study of herbs, plants, foods, oils, and natural resources through a Christian worldview.

Stewardship: Responsible care for what God has entrusted to us.

Discernment: The ability to judge wisely between what aligns with God and what does not.

Creation Worship: Giving honor, power, or spiritual devotion to created things instead of the Creator.

Educational Scope: Staying within the role of teaching and informing without diagnosing, prescribing, or treating.

Whole-Person Wellness: A view of wellness that considers spirit, soul, and body.

Lesson 1 Summary

Biblical Herbalism begins with God. He is the Creator, Sustainer, and ultimate healer. Plants are part of His provision, but they are not to be worshiped, idolized, or treated as magical. Christian students must study herbs with discernment, humility, safety, and biblical wisdom.

This course will teach students how to explore herbs through Scripture, traditional knowledge, safety awareness, and Christian stewardship. The goal is not to replace medical care or make claims, but to learn how to study and share herbal education responsibly.

As you continue through this course, remember:

Honor God first.
Study carefully.
Use discernment.
Speak responsibly.
Serve compassionately.
Stay humble.
Keep Christ at the center.

Closing Prayer

Father God,

Thank You for being the Creator of all things. Thank You for the plants, trees, herbs, seeds, fruits, and foods that You have placed upon the earth. Help me to study with humility, wisdom, and discernment. Keep me from error, pride, confusion, and anything that does not honor You.

Teach me to care for my body as Your temple. Teach me to respect creation without worshiping it. Teach me to use my words responsibly and to serve others with compassion. Let this course strengthen my faith, deepen my understanding, and help me walk in wisdom.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Instructor Closing

Students, this first lesson is the foundation for everything that follows. Before we study individual herbs, biblical foods, oils, spices, women of the Bible, or herbal preparations, we must first settle the foundation of our hearts.

We study herbs because God created them.
We use wisdom because God requires it.
We serve others because Christ taught us compassion.
We stay humble because God alone is the healer.

Welcome to Biblical Herbalism Foundations.